

Table 10.5 : Percentage Distribution of the Number of Household Heads by District, Sex, and Age Group, 2024

District	Total Number of Household Heads	%	Sex of the Head of Household				Age Group of the Head of Household					
			Male	%	Female	%	Aged below 20	%	Age 20-64	%	Aged 65 & over	%
Sri Lanka	6,111,315	100.0	4,489,242	73.5	1,622,073	26.5	8,709	0.1	4,581,256	75.0	1,521,350	24.9
Colombo	661,822	100.0	478,413	72.3	183,409	27.7	1,038	0.2	494,815	74.7	165,969	25.1
Gampaha	688,635	100.0	514,672	74.7	173,963	25.3	1,361	0.2	521,172	75.7	166,102	24.1
Kalutara	352,963	100.0	268,885	76.2	84,078	23.8	259	0.1	259,458	73.5	93,246	26.4
Kandy	397,626	100.0	290,101	73.0	107,525	27.0	413	0.1	283,723	71.4	113,490	28.5
Matale	151,132	100.0	111,566	73.8	39,566	26.2	212	0.1	112,855	74.7	38,065	25.2
Nuwara Eliya	200,261	100.0	144,240	72.0	56,021	28.0	405	0.2	151,486	75.6	48,370	24.2
Galle	307,704	100.0	225,961	73.4	81,743	26.6	313	0.1	218,546	71.0	88,845	28.9
Matara	231,946	100.0	173,237	74.7	58,709	25.3	206	0.1	161,530	69.6	70,210	30.3
Hambantota	188,638	100.0	143,131	75.9	45,507	24.1	168	0.1	136,687	72.4	51,783	27.5
Jaffna	159,753	100.0	114,699	71.8	45,054	28.2	73	0.0	111,663	69.9	48,017	30.1
Mannar	32,330	100.0	24,973	77.2	7,357	22.8	23	0.1	26,261	81.2	6,046	18.7
Vavuniya	48,399	100.0	33,699	69.6	14,700	30.4	73	0.2	38,817	80.2	9,509	19.6
Mullaitivu	34,786	100.0	23,938	68.8	10,848	31.2	66	0.2	27,638	79.4	7,082	20.4
Kilinochchi	36,734	100.0	26,944	73.3	9,790	26.7	42	0.1	29,114	79.3	7,578	20.6
Batticaloa	170,262	100.0	99,896	58.7	70,366	41.3	671	0.4	143,530	84.3	26,061	15.3
Ampara	207,007	100.0	138,860	67.1	68,147	32.9	522	0.3	171,339	82.7	35,146	17.0
Trincomalee	121,948	100.0	89,492	73.4	32,456	26.6	403	0.3	101,853	83.6	19,692	16.1
Kurunegala	511,166	100.0	376,920	73.7	134,246	26.3	598	0.1	373,491	73.1	137,077	26.8
Puttalam	234,027	100.0	169,875	72.6	64,152	27.4	436	0.2	184,728	78.9	48,863	20.9
Anuradhapura	275,084	100.0	206,378	75.0	68,706	25.0	368	0.1	219,341	79.8	55,375	20.1
Polonnaruwa	127,385	100.0	91,169	71.6	36,216	28.4	233	0.2	98,927	77.6	28,225	22.2
Badulla	248,262	100.0	188,101	75.8	60,161	24.2	240	0.1	185,602	74.8	62,420	25.1
Moneragala	151,763	100.0	119,651	78.8	32,112	21.2	128	0.1	118,576	78.1	33,059	21.8
Ratnapura	327,645	100.0	256,335	78.2	71,310	21.8	258	0.1	239,966	73.2	87,421	26.7
Kegalle	244,037	100.0	178,106	73.0	65,931	27.0	200	0.1	170,138	69.7	73,699	30.2

As shown in Table 10.5, when considering the distribution of household heads by sex and district, the highest percentage of male-headed households (78.8%) was reported in Moneragala District, while the lowest percentage (58.7%) was reported in Batticaloa District.

The highest percentage of elderly household heads (aged 65 and over) is reported from Matara district (30.3%). While the lowest percentage of that is reported from Batticaloa (15.3%) district.

The percentage distribution of female-headed households by district is clearly given in Figure 10.2 and it the Batticaloa district reports the highest percentage (41.3%) of female-headed households.